has also been recognized by the Barcelona Convention Contracting Parties as a specially protected area of Mediterranean importance (SPAMI); and

.2 The MPA cetacean migration corridor in the Mediterranean (Spain) - The Spanish government has designated a 46,385 km² corridor between Valencia, Catalonia and the Balearic Islands as a Marine Protected Area, to protect cetaceans present and migrating in the area. The Barcelona Convention, allowing the area to be designated as a SPAMI, validated this in

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SOURCE: MEPC.380(80).pdf
Valencia, Catalonia and the Balearic Islands as a Marine Protected Area, to protect cetaceans present and migrating in the area. The Barcelona Convention, allowing the area to be designated as a SPAMI, validated this in December 2019.

3.41 In addition a large number of measures have been taken for the wider protection of environments at the national level, these are listed in document MEPC 79/10.

RESOLUTION MEPC.380(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
DESIGNATION OF THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 80/17/Add.1
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ANNEX 4

ASSOCIATED PROTECTIVE MEASURE FOR THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREA (NW MED PSSA)

Associated Protective Measures (APMs)

The associated protective measures (APMs) recommendatory in nature as identified below are deemed to be applied by any commercial ships and pleasure yachts from 300 gross tonnage and upwards; the APMs would not apply to any warship and other governmental ships operated for non-commercial purposes.

1 Mariners should navigate with particular caution within the NW Med PSSA, in areas

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SOURCE: MEPC.380(80).pdf
tonnage and upwards; the APMs would not apply to any warship and other governmental ships operated for non-commercial purposes.

1 Mariners should navigate with particular caution within the NW Med PSSA, in areas where large and medium cetaceans are detected or reported, and reduce their speed to between 10 and 13 knots as voluntary speed reduction (VSR). However, a safe speed should be kept, so that proper and effective action could be taken to avoid collision and any possible negative impacts on ship's manoeuvrability.

2 Mariners should keep an appropriate safety distance or speed reduction measure from

any large and medium cetaceans observed or detected in close quarter situation. The safety distance or speed reduction measure should be adapted to the actual navigation circumstances and conditions of the ship.

3 Mariners should broadcast on VHF or other available means on scene, the position of medium and large cetaceans observed or detected within the designated PSSA and transmit the information and the position to a designated coastal Authority or Authorities.

4 Mariners should report any collision with cetaceans to a designated coastal Authority

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SOURCE: MEPC.380(80).pdf
transmit the information and the position to a designated coastal Authority or Authorities.

4 Mariners should report any collision with cetaceans to a designated coastal Authority or Authorities , which should forward this information to the International Whaling Commission (IWC) global cetacean ship strikes database.

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RESOLUTION MEPC.380(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
DESIGNATION OF THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREARESOLUTION MEPC.380(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
DESIGNATION OF THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREA

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SOURCE: MEPC.381(80).pdf
RESOLUTION MEPC.381(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH REGULATIONS 15.3, 15.5 AND 34.3 TO 34.5 OF MARPOL ANNEX I, IN RESPECT OF THE RED SEA AND THE GULF OF ADEN SPECIAL AREAS, SHALL TAKE EFFECTMEPC 80/17/Add.1
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ANNEX 21
RESOLUTION MEPC.381(80)
(adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH
REGULATIONS 15.3, 15.5 AND 34.3 TO 34.5 OF MARPOL ANNEX I, IN RESPECT OF
THE RED SEA AND THE GULF OF ADEN SPECIAL AREAS, SHALL TAKE EFFECT
THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE,
RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environment Protection Committee (the Committee) conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution from ships,
NOTING regulation 1.11.4 and 1.11.6 of Annex I of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto (MARPOL), defines the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden as Special Areas under the said Annex,

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SOURCE: MEPC.381(80).pdf
Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto (MARPOL), defines the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden as Special Areas under the said Annex,
NOTING ALSO the definition of the Special Area under MARPOL Annex I, i.e. a sea area where for recognized technical reasons in relation to its oceanographical and ecological condition and to the particular character of its traffic the adoption of special mandatory methods for the prevention of sea pollution by oil is required,
NOTING FURTHER the information provided to the Committee, at its eightieth session, by Parties, including Djibouti, Egypt, Jordan, Israel, Saudi Arabia, Somalia and the Sudan, the coastlines of which border the Red Sea Special Area, that adequate reception facilities are provided in all ports and terminals within the said Special Area, in accordance with the provisions of regulation 38.8 of MARPOL Annex I,
NOTING the information provided to the Committee, at its eightieth session, by Parties, including Djibouti and Somalia, the coastlines of which border the Gulf of Aden Special Area,

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SOURCE: MEPC.381(80).pdf
provisions of regulation 38.8 of MARPOL Annex I,
NOTING the information provided to the Committee, at its eightieth session, by Parties, including Djibouti and Somalia, the coastlines of which border the Gulf of Aden Special Area, that adequate reception facilities are provided in all ports and terminals within the said Special Area, in accordance with the provisions of regulation 38 .8 of MARPOL Annex I
HAVING CONSIDERED the matter to establish the date, on which the discharge requirements of regulations 1.11.4 and 1.11.6 of MARPOL Annex I in respect of the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden Special Areas shall take effect,
1 DECIDES that the discharge requirements of regulations 15.3, 15.5 and 34.3 to 34.5 of MARPOL Annex I in respect to the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden Special Areas shall take effect on 1 January 2025, in accordance with the requirements set out in regulati on 38.8.1 of MARPOL Annex I;
2 ENCOURAGES Member Governments, industry groups and other stakeholders to comply immediately on a voluntary basis with the Special Area requirements for the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden Special Areas;

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SOURCE: MEPC.381(80).pdf
MARPOL Annex I;
2 ENCOURAGES Member Governments, industry groups and other stakeholders to comply immediately on a voluntary basis with the Special Area requirements for the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden Special Areas;
3 REQUESTS the Secretary-General to notify, in conformity with regulation 38.8.1 of MARPOL Annex I, all Parties to MARPOL of the aforementioned decision by 31 December 2023;
4 ALSO REQUESTS the Secretary-General to notify all Members of the Organization of the aforementioned decision.
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RESOLUTION MEPC.381(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH REGULATIONS 15.3, 15.5 AND 34.3 TO 34.5 OF MARPOL ANNEX I, IN RESPECT OF THE RED SEA AND THE GULF OF ADEN SPECIAL AREAS, SHALL TAKE EFFECTRESOLUTION MEPC.381(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH REGULATIONS 15.3, 15.5 AND 34.3 TO 34.5 OF MARPOL ANNEX I, IN RESPECT OF THE RED SEA AND THE GULF OF ADEN SPECIAL AREAS, SHALL TAKE EFFECT

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SOURCE: MEPC.382(80).pdf
RESOLUTION MEPC.382(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH REGULATION 6 OF MARPOL ANNEX V, IN RESPECT OF THE RED SEA SPECIAL AREA, SHALL TAKE EFFECTMEPC 80/17/Add.1
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ANNEX 22
RESOLUTION MEPC.382(80)
(adopted on 7 July 2023)
ESTABLISHMENT OF THE DATE ON WHICH
REGULATION 6 OF MARPOL ANNEX V, IN RESPECT OF THE
RED SEA SPECIAL AREA, SHALL TAKE EFFECT
THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE,
RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environment Protection Committee (the Committee) conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution from ships,
NOTING regulation 1.14.4 of Annex V of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Protocol of 1978 relating thereto (MARPOL), defines the Red Sea area as a Special Area under the said Annex,
NOTING ALSO the definition of the Special Area under MARPOL Annex V, i.e. a sea area where for recognized technical reasons in relation to its oceanographical and ecological

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